Conservation of chimpanzees

According to the Jane Goodall Institute in Tanzania, the number of chimpanzees living in the wild has plummeted over the last century. In 1900, there were an estimated 1 million chimpanzees in Africa; today, there are fewer than 300,000. Habitat loss due to a rising human population in need of more space has had a huge impact, as have industries such as logging and mining, which destroy habitat and fragment chimp communities when roads are built through their territories. Roads also encourage another damaging activity—hunting for bushmeat, a highly valued meat in Africa that includes great apes. Roads enable hunters from towns to travel directly into the bush. The protection of chimps focuses on land conservation and on raising awareness both locally and across the globe.